Revised Guidelines for the Creation of the Internal Quality Assurance Cell (IQAC) in Accredited Institutions

A Post-Accreditation Quality Sustenance Activity

राष्ट्रीय मूल्यांकन एवं प्रत्यायन परिषद
विश्वविद्यालय अनुदान आयोग का स्वायत्त संस्थान
NATIONAL ASSESSMENT AND ACCREDITATION COUNCIL
An Autonomous Institution of the University Grants Commission
2/4, Dr. Rajkumar Road, P.O. Box No. 1075, Rajajinagar, Bangalore - 560 010, INDIA

NAAC

VISION

To make quality the defining element of higher education in India through a combination of self and external quality evaluation, promotion and sustenance initiatives.

MISSION

- *To arrange for periodic assessment and accreditation of institutions of higher education or units thereof, or specific academic programmes or projects;*
- *To stimulate the academic environment for promotion of quality of teaching-learning and research in higher education institutions;*
- *To encourage self-evaluation, accountability, autonomy and innovations in higher education;*
- *To undertake quality-related research studies, consultancy and training programmes, and*
- *To collaborate with other stakeholders of higher education for quality evaluation, promotion and sustenance.*

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Introduction

In pursuance of the National Action Plan of the National Assessment and Accreditation Council (NAAC), Bangalore, for performance evaluation, assessment and accreditation and quality upgradation of institutions of higher education, the NAAC proposes that every accredited institution establish an Internal Quality Assurance Cell (IQAC) as a post-accreditation quality sustenance measure. Since quality enhancement is a continuous process, the IQAC will become a part of an institution's system and work towards realizing the goals of quality enhancement and sustenance. The prime task of the IQAC is to develop a system for conscious, consistent and catalytic improvement in the performance of institutions. The IQAC will make a significant and meaningful contribution in the post-accreditation phase of institutions. During the post-accreditation period, the IQAC will channelise the efforts and measures of an institution towards academic excellence.

The guidelines provided in the following pages will facilitate the institution in the creation and operation of the Internal Quality Assurance Cell (IQAC). The work of the IQAC is the first step towards the internalization and institutionalization of quality enhancement. Its success depends upon the sense of belongingness and participation it can inculcate in all the constituents of the institution. It will not be yet another hierarchical structure or record-keeping exercise in the institution; it will be a facilitative and participative voluntary system / unit / organ of the institution. The IQAC has the potential to become a vehicle for ushering in quality by working out intervention strategies to remove deficiencies and enhance quality. Quality circles in industries operate on similar lines.

The basic purposes of the IQAC are:

a) *To ensure continuous improvement in the entire operations of the institution, and*

b) *To assure stakeholders connected with higher education – namely, students, parents, teachers, staff, would-be employers, funding agencies and society in general - of the accountability of the institution for its own quality and probity.*

The IQAC will evolve mechanisms and procedures for ensuring the following:

a) *Timely, efficient and progressive performance of academic, administrative and financial tasks.*

b) *The relevance and quality of academic and research programmes.*

c) *Equitable access to and affordability of academic programmes for various sections of society.*

d) *Optimization and integration of modern methods of teaching and learning.*

e) *The credibility of evaluation procedures.*

f) *The adequacy, maintenance and proper allocation of support structure and services.*

g) *Research sharing and networking with other institutions in India and abroad.*

Composition of the IQAC

The IQAC may be constituted in every institution under the chairmanship of head of the institution with heads of important academic and administrative units and a few teachers and a few distinguished educationists/ representatives of local committee. The composition of the IQAC may be as follows:

1. Chairperson: Head of the Institution
2. A few senior administrative officers
3. Three to eight teachers
4. One or two members from the Management
5. One/two nominees from local society
6. One of the teachers as the coordinator of the IQAC.

The composition of the IQAC will depend on the complexity of the organization. The norms given here therefore indicate how best the planning and monitoring need to rest on cross-sectional involvement and responsibility without the system itself becoming cumbersome.

It is necessary for the members of the IQAC to shoulder the responsibilities of generating and promoting awareness in the institution and to devote time for working out the procedural details. While selecting these members several precautions need to be taken. A few of them are listed below:

- It is advisable to choose from various backgrounds persons who have earned respect for integrity and excellence in their teaching and research. Moreover, they should be aware of the ground realities of the institutional environment. They should be known for their commitment to improving the quality of teaching and learning.
- It would be appropriate to choose as senior administrators, persons in charge of institutional services such as library, computer center, estate, student welfare, administration, academic tasks, examination, and planning and development.
- The management representatives should be persons who are aware of the institution's objectives, limitations and strengths and are committed to improvement. The local society representatives should be of high standing and should have made significant contributions to society, and, in particular, to education.

The role of the coordinator of the IQAC is crucial in ensuring the effective functioning of all the members. The coordinator of the IQAC may be a senior person with expertise in quality aspects. She/he may be a full-time functionary or, to start with, she/he may be a senior academic /administrator entrusted with the IQAC as an additional responsibility. She/he may be supported by a secretariat with one or two professional assistants on full time or on part time basis. The secretarial operation may be made technology-mediated.

Operational Features of the IQAC

Quality assurance is a by-product of ongoing efforts to define the objectives of an institution, to have a work plan to achieve them and to specify the checks and balances to evaluate the degree to which each of the tasks is fulfilled.

Hence devotion and commitment to improvement rather than mere institutional control is the basis for devising procedures and instruments for assuring quality. The right balance between the health and growth of an institution needs to be struck. The IQAC has to ensure that whatever is done in the institution for "education" is done efficiently and effectively with high standards. In order to do this, the IQAC will have to first establish procedures and modalities to collect data and information on various aspects of institutional functioning.

The Functions of the IQAC

Some of the functions expected of the IQAC are:

1. Development and application of quality benchmarks / parameters in various activities of the institution.
2. Dissemination of information on quality aspects.
3. Organization of discussions, workshops, seminars and promotion of quality circles.
4. Recording and monitoring quality measures of the institution.
5. Acting as a nodal agency of the institution for quality-related activities.
6. Preparation of the Annual Quality Assurance Report and such other reports as may be decided from time to time.

The coordinator of the IQAC and the secretary have a major role in implementing these functions. The IQAC may derive major support from the already existing units and mechanisms that contribute to the functions listed above. The operational features and functions discussed so far are broad-based to facilitate institutions towards academic excellence and institutions may adapt them to their specific needs.

The Annual Quality Assurance Report (AQAR) of the IQAC

All the accredited institutions which have established the IQAC will submit a self-reviewed progress report annually to the NAAC, detailing the tangible results achieved in key areas which are specifically identified by the IQAC in the beginning of the academic year by devising a perspective plan. The AQAR is the outcome of the perspective plan of the IQAC.

The Annual Quality Assurance Report (AQAR) of the IQAC

All accredited institutions shall submit the AQAR to the NAAC by the end of every academic year with emphasis on the following key result areas:

Name of the Institution: **Year of Report:**

Part A: The plan of action chalked out by the IQAC in the beginning of the year towards quality enhancement and the outcome achieved by the end of the year.

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Part B:

1. Activities reflecting the goals and objectives of the institution:
2. New academic programmes initiated (UG and PG):
3. Innovations in curricular design and transaction:
4. Inter-disciplinary programmes started:
5. Examination reforms implemented:
6. Candidates qualified: NET / SLET / GATE etc.
7. Initiative towards faculty development programme :
8. Total number of seminars / workshops conducted:
9. Research projects a) Newly implemented:
   b) Completed:
10. Patents generated, if any:
11. New collaborative research programmes:
12. Research grants received from various agencies:
13. Details of research scholars:
14. Citation index of faculty members and impact factor:
15. Honors / Awards to the faculty:
16. Internal resources generated:
17. Details of departments getting SAP, COSIST(ASSIST) / DST. FIST, etc. assistance / recognition:
18. Community services:

19. Teachers and officers newly recruited:
20. Teaching – Non-teaching staff ratio:
21. Improvements in the library services:
22. New books/journals subscribed and their value:
23. Courses in which student assessment of teachers is introduced and the action taken on student feedback:
24. Unit cost of education:
25. Computerization of administration and the process of admissions and examination results, issue of certificates:
26. Increase in the infrastructural facilities:
27. Technology upgradation:
28. Computer and internet access and training to teachers and students:
29. Financial aid to students:
30. Activities and support from the Alumni Association:
31 Activities and support from the Parent-Teacher Association:
32. Health services:
33. Performance in sports activities:
34. Incentives to outstanding sportspersons:
35. Student achievements and awards:
36. Activities of the Guidance and Counselling unit:
37. Placement services provided to students:
38. Development programmes for non-teaching staff:
39. Healthy practices of the institution
40. Linkages developed with National / International, academic / Research bodies
41. Any other relevant information the institution wishes to add:

Part C: Detail the plans of the institution for the next year.

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Name & Signature of the Coordinator, IQAC *Name & Signature of the Chairperson, IQAC*

For Communication with NAAC

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